

Quick Check

Lesson 2: Importance of Classification: Why Do We Need to Identify Organisms Correctly?

7 multiple-choice questions • choose A, B, C or D

Sub-Strand 1.1: Taxonomy I | Lesson 2

A family in Kakamega collects wild mushrooms for supper. They call an edible mushroom and a poisonous look-alike by the same local name. What is the most likely problem?

- A** They will only lose money because the mushrooms cannot be sold
- B** Nothing, because two organisms with the same name must be the same species
- C** Both mushrooms will become safe to eat once they are cooked
- D** They may cook and eat a poisonous mushroom, believing it is safe

Learners studied edible and poisonous mushrooms using photographs only. Which approach helps tell an edible mushroom from a deadly look-alike?

- A** Assume all mushrooms growing in the wild are safe
- B** Taste a small piece and see if it makes you sick
- C** Choose the mushroom with the name your family has always used
- D** Compare features such as the cap, gills, ring and base

Which statement about insects is correct, based on the honey bee, ladybird, mosquito and locust?

- A** An insect is harmful only if it is large
- B** All insects are pests and should be killed
- C** All insects are useful, so none need to be controlled
- D** Some insects are useful, such as honey bees and ladybirds, while others harm people or crops, such as mosquitoes and locusts

A farmer in Kericho must tell maize from couch grass and beans from black jack (*Bidens pilosa*) before weeding or spraying. Why does this identification matter?

- A** Weeds are plants, so they never affect the crop
- B** Black jack and couch grass are useful crops and should be protected
- C** Weeds make the crop taste bitter but do not affect its growth
- D** Weeds compete with crops for light, water and nutrients, and spraying the wrong plant could kill the crop

Why are local names (in Kikuyu, Luo, Kiswahili or English) alone not enough for scientists to communicate about organisms across Kenya and the world?

- A** The same organism can have different names in different languages, so people may not be sure they mean the same organism
- B** Local names are always wrong and local knowledge should be ignored
- C** Local names are too short to describe an organism
- D** Only English names can be used to describe living things

A group writes the claim 'Classification is important because it helps us identify organisms safely.' Which statement is the best piece of EVIDENCE to support this claim?

- A** Maize is grown in many parts of Kenya
- B** Classification is very useful to scientists
- C** A poisonous mushroom can look like an edible oyster mushroom, so wrongly identifying it can cause poisoning
- D** Many Kenyans enjoy eating mushrooms

Learners agreed that everyone was correct by their own criteria (habitat, colour, usefulness) and that classification helps us identify, study and communicate about organisms. What is still **MISSING** from the class model?

- A More local names for each organism
- B A common system of groups that everyone agrees to use
- C More ways to sort organisms by colour and size
- D More photographs of poisonous mushrooms

All done

Ask your teacher how to submit your answers today (for example, on a paper answer slip).